

ZACH YOUNG

Senior Software Engineer • Full-Stack (Ruby on Rails)

Cape Girardeau, MO, USA • your.email@email.com • (000) 000-0000 • [LinkedIn](#) • [Portfolio](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer with 10+ years architecting, building, and scaling high-performance web applications. Deep expertise in Ruby on Rails (full-stack and API-only), with a strong record of translating complex backend systems, integrations, and operational signals into clear, reliable, customer-facing experiences. Fluent across the modern Rails stack — Hotwire, Turbo, Stimulus — plus TypeScript and Angular. A hands-on technical leader and mentor known for strong ownership and well-tested, maintainable software.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Backend Engineering:** Ruby, Ruby on Rails (Full-Stack & API-Only), RESTful & Internal APIs, PostgreSQL, ActiveRecord, Database Optimization, Third-Party Integrations
- **Frontend Engineering:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Hotwire (Turbo, Stimulus), Angular, HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap
- **Platform & Practices:** Production Troubleshooting & Debugging, Observability, Scalable Architecture, Test-Driven Development, Code Review, Agile/Scrum
- **Leadership & Mentorship:** Technical Mentorship, Curriculum Development, Technical Instruction, Cross-Functional Collaboration
- **AI-Assisted Development:** Agentic Development with AI Coding Agents, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, OpenAI & Claude API Integration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer / Full-Stack Software Developer Mar 2017 – May 2026

Full-time | Remote | Cape Girardeau, MO

- Architected, built, and maintained scalable Ruby on Rails web applications using Hotwire, Turbo, and Stimulus, delivering reliable, high-performance experiences.
- Engineered API-only Rails backends and internal APIs that served dynamic front-end interfaces and integrated third-party services — translating complex backend systems into clean, customer-facing workflows.
- Drove agentic, AI-assisted development on the Traction Studio project with Claude Code and GitHub Copilot, migrating its runtime LLM integration from the OpenAI API to the Claude API.
- Designed and optimized ActiveRecord data models and PostgreSQL queries to improve throughput, reliability, and maintainability across high-traffic production systems.
- Owned features end-to-end across design, implementation, testing, code review, and production support — diagnosing and resolving issues to keep systems healthy and reliable.
- Modernized client-side architecture with TypeScript and Angular, improving type-safety, UI maintainability, and responsive performance.
- Partnered with cross-functional product teams to turn ambiguous requirements into well-scoped, production-ready, well-tested code.

Co-Lead Instructor / Co-Instructor, Code Labs Sep 2018 – Apr 2023

Contract (Intermittent Cohorts) | Cape Girardeau, MO (Hybrid | Remote | On-site)

- Co-led full-stack development instruction for cohorts of 40+ aspiring engineers across multiple regional hubs, including West Plains, MO and Paducah, KY.
- Co-developed and refined curriculum covering Ruby on Rails, Angular, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS.
- Mentored learners through hands-on labs and real-world team projects, raising the bar on code quality and engineering practices.
- Built relationships with local employers to connect classroom learning with regional project opportunities.

Web Developer, Team STIHL | Red Letter Communications Mar 2016 – Mar 2017

Cape Girardeau, MO

- Built and maintained web applications and digital assets supporting corporate brand strategy and a regional dealer network.

Web Designer / Front-End Developer | Woodland Companies

Jan 2015 – Jan 2017

Scottsdale, AZ

- Engineered responsive e-commerce web interfaces focused on seamless user journeys and front-

end performance optimization.

EDUCATION

B.S., Technology Management — Southeast Missouri State University

2014